

Group Theory

Definition 4.1 (Group). A group is a set G with a binary operation $*$ such that:

- (i) Closure: $a*b$ in G for all a, b in G .
- (ii) Associativity: $(a*b)*c = a*(b*c)$ for all a, b, c in G .
- (iii) Identity: there exists e in G with $e*a = a*e = a$ for all a in G .
- (iv) Inverse: for each a in G there exists a' with $a*a' = a'*a = e$.

Definition 4.2 (Abelian Group). A group is abelian if $a*b = b*a$ for all a, b .

Example 4.3. The integers $\mathbb{Z}$ under addition form an abelian group.

Definition 4.4 (Subgroup). A subset H of a group G is a subgroup if H is itself a group under the operation of G .

Theorem 4.5 (Lagrange's Theorem). If G is a finite group and H is a subgroup of G , then the order of H divides the order of G .